Forklift Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.178)

For the examination before a truck is placed in service and for site audits of forklift operations.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.178

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item affecting safety fails, take the truck out of service, report the defect and keep the truck out of use until it is repaired (1910.178(p)(1) and (q)(7)).
3. The manufacturer's instructions and your site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.178: Powered industrial trucks (Part 1910 Subpart N, Materials Handling and Storage) Source: eCFR, Title 29, as of 2026-11-09
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-178-powered-industrial-trucks

SECTION A | Truck condition and markings

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Nameplates and markings Ref. 1910.178(a)(6)	All nameplates and markings are in place and legible	☐	☐	☐	
2	Approval label Ref. 1910.178(a)(3)	Approved truck carries the testing laboratory's label or identifying mark	☐	☐	☐	
3	Modifications Ref. 1910.178(a)(4)	Any modification affecting capacity or safe operation has the manufacturer's prior written approval, and the capacity, operation and maintenance plates match it	☐	☐	☐	
4	Non-factory attachments Ref. 1910.178(a)(5)	Truck is marked with the attachment and the approximate combined weight at maximum elevation with the load laterally centered	☐	☐	☐	
5	Overhead guard Ref. 1910.178(e)(1)	High lift rider truck has an overhead guard fitted, unless operating conditions do not permit one	☐	☐	☐	
6	Load backrest extension Ref. 1910.178(e)(2)	Vertical load backrest extension fitted where the type of load presents a hazard	☐	☐	☐	
7	Fuel system Ref. 1910.178(p)(4)	No leaks anywhere in the fuel system	☐	☐	☐	
8	Water muffler Ref. 1910.178(q)(8)	Water supply is not below 75 percent of filled capacity	☐	☐	☐	
9	Exhaust Ref. 1910.178(q)(8)	No hazardous sparks or flames from the exhaust system	☐	☐	☐	
10	Cleanliness Ref. 1910.178(q)(10)	Truck is free of lint, excess oil and grease	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Examination, defects and repairs

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Examination before service Ref. 1910.178(q)(7)	Truck examined before being placed in service and at least daily	☐	☐	☐	
12	Round-the-clock use Ref. 1910.178(q)(7)	Trucks used round the clock are examined after each shift	☐	☐	☐	
13	Defect reporting Ref. 1910.178(q)(7)	Defects found are reported immediately and corrected	☐	☐	☐	
14	Unsafe trucks Ref. 1910.178(p)(1)	Any truck needing repair, defective or unsafe is out of service until restored to safe operating condition	☐	☐	☐	
15	Who repairs Ref. 1910.178(q)(1)	Repairs are made only by authorized personnel	☐	☐	☐	
16	Replacement parts Ref. 1910.178(q)(5)	Replacement parts are equivalent as to safety with the original design	☐	☐	☐	
17	Overheating Ref. 1910.178(q)(9)	No part runs above its normal operating temperature; an overheating truck stays out of service until the cause is eliminated	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Operator training and certification

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
18	Trained before driving Ref. 1910.178(l)(1)(ii)	Every operator completed training before driving, other than for training purposes	☐	☐	☐	
19	Certification record Ref. 1910.178(l)(6)	Record names the operator, gives the training date and evaluation date, and identifies who trained or evaluated	☐	☐	☐	
20	Three-year evaluation Ref. 1910.178(l)(4)(iii)	Each operator's performance evaluated within the last three years	☐	☐	☐	
21	Refresher training Ref. 1910.178(l)(4)(ii)	Refresher training given after unsafe operation, an accident or near-miss, a failed evaluation, assignment to a different truck type, or a workplace change affecting safe operation	☐	☐	☐	
22	Trainee supervision Ref. 1910.178(l)(2)(i)	Trainees drive only under direct supervision of a qualified trainer and where no one is endangered	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Battery charging and refueling

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
23	Charging location Ref. 1910.178(g)(1)	Charging installation is in an area designated for that purpose	☐	☐	☐	
24	Charging facilities Ref. 1910.178(g)(2)	Electrolyte flushing and neutralizing, fire protection, charger protection from trucks, and ventilation for battery fumes are provided	☐	☐	☐	
25	Battery handling equipment Ref. 1910.178(g)(4)	Conveyor, overhead hoist or equivalent equipment provided for handling batteries	☐	☐	☐	
26	Electrolyte handling Ref. 1910.178(g)(6)	Carboy tilter or siphon provided	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION D | Battery charging and refueling

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
27	Truck position before charging Ref. 1910.178(g)(8)	Truck properly positioned and brake applied before batteries are changed or charged	☐	☐	☐	
28	Vent caps and covers Ref. 1910.178(g)(9)	Battery vent caps are functioning and battery (or compartment) covers are open to dissipate heat	☐	☐	☐	
29	No smoking Ref. 1910.178(g)(10)	Smoking is prohibited in the charging area	☐	☐	☐	
30	Ignition sources Ref. 1910.178(g)(11)	Precautions in place to prevent open flames, sparks or electric arcs in the charging area	☐	☐	☐	
31	Metal objects Ref. 1910.178(g)(12)	Tools and other metallic objects kept away from the top of uncovered batteries	☐	☐	☐	
32	Refueling Ref. 1910.178(p)(2)	Engine is off whenever the fuel tank is filled	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Operating area and work practices

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
33	Location classified Ref. 1910.178(b)(12)	Atmosphere or location has been classified as hazardous or nonhazardous before trucks are used there	☐	☐	☐	
34	Approved trucks in hazardous locations Ref. 1910.178(m)(11)	Only approved trucks are used in hazardous locations	☐	☐	☐	
35	Lighting Ref. 1910.178(h)(2)	Auxiliary directional lighting on the truck where general lighting is less than 2 lumens per square foot	☐	☐	☐	
36	Carbon monoxide Ref. 1910.178(i)(1)	Carbon monoxide from truck operations does not exceed the levels in 1910.1000	☐	☐	☐	
37	Fire aisles and equipment Ref. 1910.178(m)(14)	Fire aisles, stairway access and fire equipment are clear	☐	☐	☐	
38	Headroom Ref. 1910.178(m)(8)	Sufficient headroom under lights, pipes, sprinklers and other overhead installations	☐	☐	☐	
39	Highway trucks at docks Ref. 1910.178(k)(1)	Brakes set and wheel chocks under the rear wheels while the trailer is boarded	☐	☐	☐	
40	Railroad cars Ref. 1910.178(k)(2)	Wheel stops or other recognized positive protection keep railroad cars from moving during loading	☐	☐	☐	
41	Dockboards Ref. 1910.178(n)(11)	Dockboards and bridge plates are secured before being driven over	☐	☐	☐	
42	Unattended trucks Ref. 1910.178(m)(5)(i)	Forks fully lowered, controls neutral, power off and brakes set; wheels blocked on an incline	☐	☐	☐	

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DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME